# SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

**13 October 2020 · Shift 3**

47 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 53 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

## English Language (Basic Knowledge) 23 questions

**Q.1**

Select the correctly spelt word.

**(A)** Restaurent
**(B)** Memmoir
**(C)** Business
**(D)** Studiuous

**Q.2**

Select the synonym of the given word. Nebulous

**(A)** Stable
**(B)** Dearly
**(C)** Faith
**(D)** Vague

**Q.4**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. METROPOLITAN

**(A)** National
**(B)** Insular
**(C)** Federal
**(D)** Provincial

**Q.5**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. A city, predominantly made of red sandstone, Fatehpur Sikri (1)_____ founded in the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar. It is essentially a fortified city (2)_____ had been the capital of Akbar (3)_____ fifteen years. Now a UNESCO world heritage site (4)_____ a famous tourist attraction, it is a fine (5)_____ of Mughal architecture.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** had
**(B)** was
**(C)** were
**(D)** is

**Q.6**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. A city, predominantly made of red sandstone, Fatehpur Sikri (1)_____ founded in the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar. It is essentially a fortified city (2)_____ had been the capital of Akbar (3)_____ fifteen years. Now a UNESCO world heritage site (4)_____ a famous tourist attraction, it is a fine (5)_____ of Mughal architecture.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** who
**(B)** which
**(C)** where
**(D)** what

**Q.7**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. A city, predominantly made of red sandstone, Fatehpur Sikri (1)_____ founded in the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar. It is essentially a fortified city (2)_____ had been the capital of Akbar (3)_____ fifteen years. Now a UNESCO world heritage site (4)_____ a famous tourist attraction, it is a fine (5)_____ of Mughal architecture.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** by
**(B)** since
**(C)** for
**(D)** from

**Q.8**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. A city, predominantly made of red sandstone, Fatehpur Sikri (1)_____ founded in the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar. It is essentially a fortified city (2)_____ had been the capital of Akbar (3)_____ fifteen years. Now a UNESCO world heritage site (4)_____ a famous tourist attraction, it is a fine (5)_____ of Mughal architecture.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** and
**(B)** if
**(C)** but
**(D)** nor

**Q.9**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. A city, predominantly made of red sandstone, Fatehpur Sikri (1)_____ founded in the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar. It is essentially a fortified city (2)_____ had been the capital of Akbar (3)_____ fifteen years. Now a UNESCO world heritage site (4)_____ a famous tourist attraction, it is a fine (5)_____ of Mughal architecture.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** ruin
**(B)** example
**(C)** organization
**(D)** infrastructure

**Q.10**

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Lasting for a very short time

**(A)** Illusory
**(B)** Infinite
**(C)** Ephemeral
**(D)** Endless

**Q.11**

Select the option that is the passive form of the given sentence. The police brought a search warrant when they raided his house.

**(A)** A search warrant was brought by the police when they raided his house.
**(B)** A search warrant was brought when they raided his house by the police.
**(C)** The police had raided his house and brought a search warrant.
**(D)** A search warrant had been brought when the police raided his house.

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. INSTANT

**(A)** Gradual
**(B)** Diverse
**(C)** Similar
**(D)** Prompt

**Q.13**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. “Since it falls” on the floor, her dog, a black Labrador, gulped the biscuit down.

**(A)** Since it fell
**(B)** Because it is falling
**(C)** No improvement
**(D)** As it have fallen

**Q.14**

Select the option that is the direct form of the given sentence. Nidhi exclaimed that it was a beautiful painting.

**(A)** Nidhi exclaimed, “What a beautiful painting!”
**(B)** Nidhi said to the artist, “That looks like a beautiful painting!”
**(C)** Nidhi said to the artist in surprise, “How beautiful you made that painting!”
**(D)** Nidhi told him in wonder, “How beautiful!”

**Q.15**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Excess
**(B)** Discriminatory
**(C)** Supportors
**(D)** Inclusion

**Q.16**

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Tending to associate with others of one's kind

**(A)** Genial
**(B)** Gregarious
**(C)** Harmonious
**(D)** Congruous

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Akshay is likely to “take the heat” for having miscalculated the expenses.

**(A)** enjoy warm climate
**(B)** feel very hot
**(C)** receive criticism
**(D)** scold everyone

**Q.18**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiom. To have a gut feeling

**(A)** To have pain in the abdomen
**(B)** To experience discomfort
**(C)** To suffer from inflammation
**(D)** To feel an instinct or intuition

**Q.19**

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. They grew cabbages and carrots in their back yard. B. The family was very poor and was always hungry because there was a war on. C. They also had a chicken, which provided the family with eggs, but still they were hungry. D. Their country had been invaded by a foreign army.

**(A)** BDAC
**(B)** DABC
**(C)** CADB
**(D)** CDAB

**Q.20**

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. I sow a seed. B. I saw the sapling. C. I saw the sprout. D. I saw the plant.

**(A)** CABD
**(B)** ABCD
**(C)** ACBD
**(D)** DBAC

**Q.21**

Identify the segment in the given sentence which contains the grammatical error. Most of voters in Taiwan seem to have once again voted for the democratic party and President Tsai Ing-wen.

**(A)** the democratic party
**(B)** in Taiwan seem to have
**(C)** once again voted for
**(D)** Most of voters

**Q.23**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank in the given sentence. The performances of the notable dancers and guest artists _____ the audience.

**(A)** immersed
**(B)** occupied
**(C)** enthralled
**(D)** absorbed

**Q.24**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. This is a class “who is expected to do” exceptionally well in the quiz next week.

**(A)** which is expected to do
**(B)** which are expecting to be doing
**(C)** that is expecting to done
**(D)** No improvement

**Q.25**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. RIND

**(A)** Leaf
**(B)** Peel
**(C)** Shade
**(D)** Petal

## General Awareness 24 questions

**Q.1**

When was the ‘Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award’ instituted?

**(A)** 1985-86
**(B)** 2002-03
**(C)** 1991–92
**(D)** 1993-94

**Q.2**

Who was sworn in as the 11th Chief Minister of Jharkhand on 29 December 2019?

**(A)** Raghubar Das
**(B)** Shibu Soren
**(C)** Alamgir Alam
**(D)** Hemant Soren

**Q.3**

As per state census 2011, which of the following is the least populous state of India?

**(A)** Sikkim
**(B)** Tamil Nadu
**(C)** Kerala
**(D)** Odisha

**Q.4**

Which player became the first Indian brand ambassador of La Liga (the top tier of Spanish club football) in December 2019?

**(A)** Rohit Sharma
**(B)** Mahendra Singh Dhoni
**(C)** Virat Kohli
**(D)** Sachin Tendulkar

**Q.5**

On December 2019, the Prime Minister of _____ announced the commencement of the ‘Gandhi Citizenship Education Award’ to be given every year.

**(A)** Portugal
**(B)** Japan
**(C)** Bhutan
**(D)** France

**Q.6**
What was India's rank in the world in terms of military power as per the 'Global Firepower Nations Index 2019'?

**(A)** 3rd
**(B)** 5th
**(C)** 4th
**(D)** 9th

**Q.7**
Which festival marks the beginning of the Tibetan New Year?

**(A)** Saga Dawa Festival
**(B)** Losar festival
**(C)** Shoton Festival
**(D)** Ongkor Festival

**Q.8**
Which instrument records the waves reaching the surface during an earthquake?

**(A)** Barograph
**(B)** Seismograph
**(C)** Manometer
**(D)** Chronometer

**Q.9**
Which scientist arranged the Periodic Table of Elements in the order of increasing atomic masses?

**(A)** Robert Boyle
**(B)** Henry Moseley
**(C)** William Ramsay
**(D)** Dmitri Mendeleev

**Q.10**
What is the chemical name of 'oil of vitriol'?

**(A)** Calcium hydroxide
**(B)** Methyl alcohol
**(C)** Sulfuric acid
**(D)** Sodium chloride

**Q.11**
In which year did Motilal Nehru (Chairman) and eight other Congress leaders draft a constitution for India?

**(A)** 1925
**(B)** 1950
**(C)** 1928
**(D)** 1930

**Q.12**
Which planet is made up of thick white and yellowish clouds of sulfuric acid?

**(A)** Mars
**(B)** Uranus
**(C)** Neptune
**(D)** Venus

**Q.14**
Which of the following pairs is INCORRECTLY matched?

**(A)** Indian Oil Corporation Limited – Maharatna
**(B)** Hindustan Aeronautics Limited – Navratna
**(C)** Airport Authority of India – Navratna
**(D)** Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited – Miniratna

**Q.15**
What is the provision of Article 49 of the Constitution of India?

**(A)** Provision for free and compulsory education for children
**(B)** Protection of monuments and places and objects of natural importance
**(C)** Prohibition of employment of children (Under the age of 14) in factories and mines
**(D)** Promotion of international peace and security

**Q.16**
Which of the following temples has Panchayatana Style of architecture?

**(A)** Sun Temple
**(B)** Kashi Vishwanath temple
**(C)** Brihadeeswara Temple
**(D)** Dashavatara Temple

**Q.17**
In which language were the Mughal court chronicles written?

**(A)** Sanskrit
**(B)** Hindi
**(C)** Persian
**(D)** Urdu

**Q.18**
Which of the following prominent leaders wrote the book 'Citizen Delhi: My Life, My Times'?

**(A)** Arvind Kejriwal
**(B)** Arun Jaitley
**(C)** Harsh Vardhan
**(D)** Sheila Dikshit

**Q.19**
Who designed the first analog computer in India?

**(A)** Samarendra Kumar Mitra
**(B)** Deb Kumar Bose
**(C)** Subodh Chandra Das Gupta
**(D)** Bimal Kumar Bhattacharyya

**Q.20**
Which of the following monuments has NOT been notified as a National Geo-heritage Monument by the Geological Survey of India (GSI)?

**(A)** Pillow Lava in Iron Ore belt at Nomira, Odisha
**(B)** Peninsular Gneiss Lalbagh, Karnataka
**(C)** Nagahill Ophiolite site near Pungro, Nagaland
**(D)** Gingee Fort Villupuram District, Tamil Nadu

**Q.21**
In DASD, what is the full form of 'A'?

**(A)** Around
**(B)** Accessible
**(C)** Arithmetic
**(D)** Access

**Q.22**
Which child activist became the first Indian to be awarded the 'Changemaker Award 2019' (given by the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation) for her work towards abolition of child marriage in Rajasthan?

**(A)** Ayushi Dholakia
**(B)** Kanchan Upadhaya
**(C)** Ridhima Pandey
**(D)** Payal Jangid

**Q.23**
Which former badminton player of India was awarded the 'Sportstar Lifetime Achievement Award' in February 2019?

**(A)** Sanave Thomas
**(B)** Prakash Padukone
**(C)** Chetan Anand
**(D)** Pullela Gopichand

**Q.24**
Which Indian mountain looks like a giant pyramid and has a flat summit area and two peaks?

**(A)** Mamostang Kangri
**(B)** Saltoro Kangri
**(C)** Kamet
**(D)** Nanda Devi

**Q.25**
Which Indian economist was appointed as the Chief Economist of the World Bank from 2012 to 2016?

**(A)** Kaushik Basu
**(B)** Jagdish Bhagwati
**(C)** Indraprasad Gordhanbhai Patel
**(D)** Raghuram Rajan

## Answer key

### English Language (Basic Knowledge)

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(B)** | Q.7 **(C)** |
| Q.8 **(A)** | Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(A)** | Q.12 **(A)** | Q.13 **(A)** |
| Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(A)** |
| Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(B)** | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(C)** | Q.12 **(D)** |
| Q.14 **(C)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(A)** |
| Q.20 **(D)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(A)** |

## Explanations

### English Language (Basic Knowledge)

**Q.1 · Answer (C) Business**

'Business' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'restaurant', 'memoir' and 'studious'.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) Vague**

'Nebulous' means unclear or ill-defined, as an idea or plan can be: 'vague'.

**Q.4 · Answer (D) Provincial**

'Metropolitan' describes a big city and its sophisticated ways; its opposite is 'provincial', of the regions outside the capital and often narrow in outlook.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) was**

The singular subject 'Fatehpur Sikri' takes the past passive 'was founded': it was founded in the 16th century.

**Q.6 · Answer (B) which**

The relative pronoun for a thing is 'which': 'a fortified city which had been the capital of Akbar'.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) for**

'For' goes with a length of time: 'for fifteen years'. 'Since' and 'from' need a starting point.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) and**

'And' joins two descriptions that sit together: 'a UNESCO world heritage site and a famous tourist attraction'.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) example**

A building that shows a style well is 'a fine example' of it: 'a fine example of Mughal architecture'.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) Ephemeral**

'Ephemeral' means lasting for a very short time. 'Infinite' and 'endless' mean the opposite, and 'illusory' means not real.

**Q.11 · Answer (A) A search warrant was brought by the police when they raided his house.**

The simple past 'brought' becomes 'was brought' with the subject 'a search warrant', and 'by the police' follows the verb; the 'when' clause stays as it is.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) Gradual**

'Instant' means happening at once; its opposite is 'gradual', happening slowly over time. 'Prompt' is close to it in meaning.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) Since it fell**

The main verb 'gulped' is in the past, so the reason clause must be in the past too: 'Since it fell on the floor'.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) Nidhi exclaimed, “What a beautiful painting!”**

'Exclaimed that it was a beautiful painting' reports an exclamation, which in direct speech is 'What a beautiful painting!'

**Q.15 · Answer (C) Supportors**

'Supportors' is misspelt: the word is 'supporters'.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) Gregarious**

'Gregarious' describes people or animals that like to be with others of their kind. 'Genial' means friendly and cheerful, and 'harmonious' and 'congruous' mean in agreement.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) receive criticism**

To 'take the heat' is to face criticism or blame for something: here, for the miscalculated expenses.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) To feel an instinct or intuition**

A 'gut feeling' is an instinctive sense that something is true, without any reasoning behind it.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) BDAC**
B introduces the poor, hungry family and the war, and D explains the war (the country had been invaded). A says what they grew, and C, with 'also', adds the chicken and ends on their hunger: BDAC.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) ACBD**
A plant grows from a seed to a sprout, then a sapling and then a full plant: ACBD.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) Most of voters**
'Most of' needs a determiner before the noun: 'Most of the voters', or simply 'Most voters'.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) enthralled**
To 'enthral' is to captivate and delight, which is what fine performances do to an audience. 'Immersed' and 'absorbed' are normally said of the audience itself ('absorbed in the performance'), and 'occupied' does not fit.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) which is expected to do**
'Class' here is a group taken as one unit, not a person, so it takes 'which' and a singular verb: 'This is a class which is expected to do exceptionally well'.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) Peel**
The 'rind' is the tough outer skin of a fruit such as an orange or a melon: its 'peel'.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (C) 1991–92**
The Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna, India's highest sporting honour, was instituted in 1991-92; the chess player Viswanathan Anand was its first recipient. It was renamed the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna in 2021.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) Hemant Soren**
Hemant Soren of the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha was sworn in as Chief Minister of Jharkhand on 29 December 2019, after his alliance won the state election; he succeeded Raghubar Das.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) Sikkim**
The 2011 Census counted about 6.1 lakh people in Sikkim, the fewest of any state.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Rohit Sharma**
In December 2019 La Liga named the cricketer Rohit Sharma its first brand ambassador in India; he was also the first non-footballer it had made a brand ambassador anywhere.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) Portugal**
Portugal's Prime Minister, António Costa, announced an annual Gandhi Citizenship Education Prize in December 2019, at a meeting of India's national committee for the 150th anniversary of Gandhi's birth.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) 4th**
The Global Firepower index for 2019 ranked India's military fourth in the world, after the United States, Russia and China.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) Losar festival**
Losar is the Tibetan New Year festival. Saga Dawa marks the Buddha's birth, enlightenment and death, and Shoton is Lhasa's yoghurt festival.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) Seismograph**
A seismograph records the seismic waves of an earthquake. A barograph records air pressure, a manometer measures the pressure of a fluid and a chronometer keeps precise time.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) Dmitri Mendeleev**
Dmitri Mendeleev arranged the elements by increasing atomic mass in his periodic table of 1869. Henry Moseley later showed that atomic number is the better basis.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) Sulfuric acid**
'Oil of vitriol' is the old name for concentrated sulfuric acid, $H_2SO_4$.

**Q.11 · Answer (C) 1928**
The Nehru Report of 1928, drawn up by a committee chaired by Motilal Nehru, was a draft constitution for India that asked for dominion status.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) Venus**
Venus is wrapped in thick clouds of sulfuric acid, which reflect most of the sunlight and make it the brightest planet in our sky.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) Airport Authority of India – Navratna**
When the exam was held, in October 2020, the Airports Authority of India was a Miniratna (Category I), not a Navratna. Indian Oil was a Maharatna, Hindustan Aeronautics a Navratna and BSNL a Miniratna (Category I).

**Q.15 · Answer (B) Protection of monuments and places and objects of natural importance**
Article 49, a Directive Principle, obliges the State to protect monuments, places and objects of artistic or historic interest declared to be of national importance (the option prints 'natural'). Child labour in factories and mines is barred by Article 24, and Article 51 promotes international peace and security.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Dashavatara Temple**
The Gupta-period Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh is in the panchayatana style: a main shrine on a platform with four smaller shrines at its corners.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) Persian**
Persian was the language of the Mughal court, and its chronicles, such as the Akbar Nama, were written in it.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) Sheila Dikshit**
Sheila Dikshit, Chief Minister of Delhi from 1998 to 2013, published her memoir in 2018 as 'Citizen Delhi: My Times, My Life' (the question swaps the two halves of the subtitle).

**Q.19 · Answer (A) Samarendra Kumar Mitra**
Samarendra Kumar Mitra designed and built India's first analog computer at the Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata, in 1953-54.

**Q.20 · Answer (D) Gingee Fort Villupuram District, Tamil Nadu**
The Geological Survey of India has notified the pillow lavas at Nomira, the Peninsular Gneiss at Lalbagh and the Nagahill ophiolite near Pungro as National Geo-heritage Monuments. Gingee Fort is a historical fort, not a geological site.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) Access**
DASD stands for Direct Access Storage Device, such as a hard disk, where data can be reached directly rather than in sequence as on tape.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) Payal Jangid**
Payal Jangid of Rajasthan received the Gates Foundation's Changemaker Award at its Goalkeepers awards in September 2019 for her campaign against child marriage.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) Prakash Padukone**
Prakash Padukone, the 1980 All England champion, received the Lifetime Achievement Award at the Sportstar Aces Awards in Mumbai in February 2019.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) Kamet**
Kamet (7,756 m), in the Garhwal Himalaya of Uttarakhand, rises like a giant pyramid topped by a flat summit area with two peaks.

**Q.25 · Answer (A) Kaushik Basu**
Kaushik Basu was Chief Economist and Senior Vice-President of the World Bank from 2012 to 2016. Raghuram Rajan had earlier been the IMF's chief economist.

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